

under glass in cold-winter regions, in partial shade and well-drained soil; water sparingly. Do not allow water to remain on the leaves, or they will be susceptible to botrytis. Propagate in spring, by seed, leaf cuttings, or division of rhizomes.

Rhizomatous begonias

Variable, mostly evergreen, rhizomatous perennials, grown for their foliage and small, single flowers. Smooth, crested or puckered, green or brown leaves, 3–12in (8–30cm) long, often marked silver, are sometimes spirally twisted. Creeping cultivars are more freely branched than erect ones and are useful for hanging baskets. Enjoys 40–75% relative humidity. Grow under glass in cool climates, in partial shade and in well-drained soil; water only sparingly. Do not allow water to remain on the leaves, or they will be susceptible to botrytis. Propagate in spring by seed, leaf cuttings, or division of rhizomes.

Semperflorens begonias

Evergreen, bushy perennials, derived from *B. cucullata* var. *hookeri*, *B. schmidtiana* and other species, often grown as bedding annuals. Stems are soft, succulent, and branch freely, bearing generally rounded, green, bronze, or variegated leaves, 2in (5cm) long. Flowers are single or double. Pinch out growing tips to produce bushy plants. Needs sun or partial shade and well-drained soil. Propagate in spring by seed or stem cuttings.

Shrublike begonias

Evergreen, multistemmed, bushy perennials, usually freely branched, with flexible, erect or pendent stems, often hairy. Leaves may be hairy or glabrous, up to 6in (15cm) across and 4–12in (10–30cm) long. Single flowers are pink, cream or white. Prefers 55% relative humidity. Grow under glass in good light and in moist but well-drained soil. Propagate in spring by seed or stem cuttings.

Tuberous begonias (including the Tuberhybrida, Multiflora and Pendula begonias)

Mostly upright, bushy, tuberous, winter-dormant perennials grown for their foliage and flowers. Tuberhybrida begonias, H and S 30in (75cm), vary from pendent to erect, with sparsely branched, succulent stems and ovate, pointed, glossy, bright to dark green leaves, 8in (20cm) long. Most are summer-flowering and double-flowered. Multiflora cultivars, H and S 12in (30cm), are bushier and have 3in (8cm) long leaves, and single, semidouble or double, flowers, each 1½–2in (4–5cm) across, in summer; they tolerate full sun. Pendula cultivars, H to 3ft (1m), have long, thin, trailing stems; leaves are 2½–3in (6–8cm) long. Abundant single or double flowers are borne in summer. Outdoors, grow in dappled shade and moist conditions; under glass, plant in cool shade with 65–70% relative humidity. Tubers are dormant in winter. Start into growth in spring for midsummer to early-fall flowering. Remove all flower buds until stems show at least 3 pairs of leaves; with large-flowered types, remove

flanking buds and allow only central male bud to flower. Plants may require staking. Propagate in spring by seed, stem, or basal cuttings or division of tubers.

Winter-flowering begonias

Evergreen, low-growing, very compact perennials, with succulent, thin stems, that are often included in the tuberous group. Two main groups are recognized: the single-flowered, usually pink or white, Lorraine, Cheimantha, or Christmas begonias; and the single, semidouble or double, Elatior and Rieger begonias that occur in a wide range of colors. Leaves are green or bronze, 2in (5cm) long. Flowers are borne mainly from late fall to midspring. Enjoys 40% relative humidity. Indirect sun and moist soil are preferred. Cut old stems to 4in (10cm) after flowering. Propagate in spring by seed or stem cuttings.

B. albopicta (illus. p.317). Fast-growing, evergreen, cane-stemmed begonia. H to 3ft (1m), S 1ft (30cm). Freely branching, green stems turn brown-green when mature. Narrowly ovate to lance-shaped, wavy-edged, green leaves are silver-spotted. Produces clusters of single, green-white flowers in summer. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C)

B. angularis, syn. *B. compta*, *B. stipulacea* of gardens, *B. zebrina*. Evergreen, cane-stemmed begonia. H 2ft (60cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Bears well-branched, angular stems and ovate, wavy-edged, 4–6in (10–15cm) long, gray-green leaves, with silver-gray veins, pale green beneath. Single, white flowers are produced throughout the year. Z13–15 (min. 50°F/10°C)

B. ‘Beatrice Haddrell’. Evergreen, creeping, rhizomatous begonia. H 8–12in (20–30cm), S 10–12in (25–30cm). Ovate leaves are deeply cleft, 3–6in (8–15cm) long, and dark green with paler veins. Produces single, pink flowers, above foliage, in winter. Z13–15

B. ‘Benitochiba’ (illus. p.317). Rhizomatous begonia. H 12in (30cm) or more, S 15in (38cm). Has palmate leaves, 8in (20cm) or more across, comprising 6–8 toothed, narrowly ovate leaflets with red leaf-stalks; leaves are silver-gray suffused pink when young, later turning silver. In fall and early winter, produces small clusters of pink flowers. Z9–11 (min. 50°F/10°C)

B. ‘Bethlehem Star’. Evergreen, creeping, rhizomatous begonia. H 8–12in (20–30cm), S 10–12in (25–30cm). Has ovate, slightly indented, almost black leaves, to 3in (8cm) long, each with a central, creamy-green star. In winter, bears profuse, single, pale pink flowers, with darker pink spots. Z13–15 (min. 50°F/10°C)

B. ‘Billie Langdon’ (illus. p.317). Upright Tuberhybrida begonia. H 2ft (60cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Bears abundant, heavily veined, double, white flowers, each 7in (18cm) across, with a perfect rose-bud center, in summer. Z13–15 (min. 50°F/10°C)

B. ‘Bokit’. Evergreen, erect, rhizomatous begonia. H 8–12in (20–30cm), S 10–14in (25–35cm). Has ovate, spirally twisted, yellow-green leaves with brown tiger stripes. Bears abundant, single, white flowers, flecked with pink, in winter. Z13–15 (min. 50°F/10°C)

B. boliviensis ‘Bonfire’. See *B. BONFIRE* (‘Nzcone’).

B. BONFIRE (‘Nzcone’), syn. *B. boliviensis* ‘Bonfire’ (illus. p.317). Semitrailing begonia. H 30in (75cm), S 3ft (1m). Succulent stems bear lance-shaped, slightly hairy leaves, 5in (12cm) long, with narrow, toothed, red edges. Produces abundant, pendulous, single, orange-red flowers from late spring to fall. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C)

B. bowerae (Eyelash begonia; illus. p.317). Evergreen, creeping, rhizomatous begonia. H 10–12in (25–30cm), S 8–10in (20–25cm). Has ovate, bright green leaves, 1in (25cm) long, with chocolate marks and bristles around edges. Bears single, pink-tinted, white flowers freely in winter. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C)

B. ‘Can-can’ illus. p.323. **B. carolineifolia**. Rhizomatous begonia with an erect, branched, woody rhizome. H 3ft (1m), S 1½ft (45cm). Palmate, dark green leaves, 12in (30cm) across, are divided into 6–10 short-stalked, wavy-margined, lance-shaped to ovate leaflets. Bears pale pink flowers, with darker spots, in late winter and spring. Z10–11 (min. 50°F/10°C)

B. coccinea (Angelwing begonia). Evergreen, cane-stemmed begonia. H 4ft (1.2m), S 1ft (30cm). Produces narrowly ovate, glossy, green leaves, buff-colored beneath, and, in spring, many single, pink or coral-red flowers. Z13–15 (min. 50°F/10°C)

B. ‘Cocktail Series’. Semperflorens begonia. H and S 8–12in (20–30cm). Has rounded, wavy, green-bronze leaves and pink, red or white flowers, from summer until fall frosts. Z13–15 (min. 50°F/10°C)

B. compta. See *B. angularis*.

B. ‘Corallina de Lucerna’. See *B. ‘Lucerna’*.

B. dichroa. Evergreen, cane-stemmed begonia. H 14in (35cm), S 10in (25cm). Ovate leaves are mid-green, 5in (12cm) long; new leaves occasionally have silver spots. Bears small, single, orange flowers, with a white ovary, in summer. Z13–15 (min. 50°F/10°C)

B. DRAGON WING RED (‘Bepared’) (Dragon Wing Series; illus. p.317). Vigorous, Semperflorens begonia. H and S 1½ft (45cm). Semitrailing, succulent stems bear ovate, slightly waxy, mid-green leaves, 2–3in (5–8cm). Produces clusters of single, scarlet flowers from late summer to fall. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C)

B. dregei (Mapleleaf begonia; illus. p.317). Tuberous begonia. H 30in (75cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has small, maplelike, lobed, purple-veined, bronze leaves, red beneath and at times silver-speckled when young. Bears profuse, pendent, single, white flowers in summer. Needs winter rest. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C)

B. ‘Erythrophylla’, syn. *B. ‘Feastii’*. Evergreen, creeping, rhizomatous begonia. H 8in (20cm), S 9–12in (23–30cm). Thick, mid-green leaves, 3–6in (8–15cm) long, are almost rounded, with leaf stalks attached to center of red undersides; slightly wavy margins have white hairs. Bears single, light pink flower, above the leaves, in early spring. Z13–15 (min. 50°F/10°C)

B. ‘Escargot’ (illus. p.317). Rex-cultorum begonia. H 10in (25cm), S 18–20in (45–50cm). Has asymmetric, ovate, hairy, olive-green leaves, 9½–12in (24–30cm) long, each with a snaillike, central silver

band. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C) **B. ‘Feastii’**. See *B. ‘Erythrophylla’*. **B. ‘Fireworks’**. Rex-cultorum begonia. H 8in (20cm) or more, S 12in (30cm). Bears puckered, pointed, heart-shaped, silver-gray leaves, to 10in (25cm) long, with purple veins and raspberry-red margins. Z9–11 (min. 50°F/10°C)

B. foliosa. Evergreen, shrublike begonia. H 12–20in (30–50cm), S 12–14in (30–35cm). Bears erect, then arching stems and ovate, toothed, dark green leaves, ½in (1cm) long. Has very small, single, white flowers in spring and fall. Z13–15 (min. 50°F/10°C). **var. miniata** (syn. *B. fuchsiioides*, *B. fuchsoides* var. *miniata*; Fuchsia begonia) H to 4ft (1.2m), S 1ft (30cm), has numerous ovate, toothed dark green leaves, 1½in (4cm) long. Pendent, single, bright red flowers are borne in winter.

B. fuchsoides. See *B. foliosa* var. *miniata*. **B. fuchsoides** var. *miniata*. See *B. foliosa* var. *miniata*.

B. ‘Gloire de Lorraine’ (Christmas begonia, Lorraine begonia). Evergreen, winter-flowering, Cheimantha begonia. H 12in (30cm), S 12–14in (30–35cm). Well-branched with rounded, bright green leaves and single, white to pale pink flowers. Male flowers are sterile, female, highly infertile. Z13–15 (min. 50°F/10°C) **B. gracilis** var. *martiniana*. See *B. martiana*.

B. grandis subsp. *evansiana*. See *B. grandis* subsp. *grandis*.

B. grandis subsp. *grandis*, syn. *B. grandis* subsp. *evansiana*, illus. p.278.

B. ‘Green Gold’. Rex-cultorum begonia. H 12in (30cm), S 15in (38cm). Bears ovate, light green leaves, 8in (20cm) long, with brown-marked, spirally arranged basal lobes and margins, and red-marked undersides. Z9–11 (min. 50°F/10°C)

B. haageana. See *B. scharffii*.

B. Illumination Series. Double and semidouble Pendula begonia. H 2ft (60cm), S 12in (30cm). Has ovate, toothed, brightly veined, mid- to dark green leaves. Bears prolific, double flowers, 3in (8cm) across, in red, pink, orange and yellow shades, and white, including bicolors. Z13–15. **‘Illumination Salmon Pink’** (illus. p.317) is pale salmon-pink.

B. imperialis. Rhizomatous begonia. H 5in (13cm), S 9in (23cm). Ovate, toothed, light green leaves, 4in (10cm) long, have puckered edges and silver-green splashes on the main veins. Produces sprays of sparse white flowers, to ½in (1cm) across, in winter. Z13–15 (min. 50°F/10°C)

B. ‘Inferno’. Vigorous tuberous begonia with trailing stems. H and S 12in (30cm). Has lance-shaped, bright green leaves. From summer to fall, bears weather-resistant, pendulous, single, bright orange-red flowers. Z9–11 (min. 50°F/10°C)

B. ‘Iron Cross’. See *B. masoniana*. **B. listada**. Shrublike begonia. H 12in (30cm) or more, S 20in (50cm). Has softly hairy, shield-shaped, olive-green leaves, 3–4in (8–10cm) long, with a central band of pale emerald-green and red undersides. Pink-tinted, white flowers are borne sporadically all year. Z9–11 (min. 50°F/10°C) **B. ‘Little Brother Montgomery’**. Shrublike begonia. H 16in (40cm), S 18in (45cm). Has maplelike, silver-spotted, deep